MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM

MGU-UGP (HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION OCTOBER 2025

THIRD SEMESTER

VAC-MG3VACECO200 – GENDER AND ECONOMICS

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

SCHEME OF VALUATION

Duration: 1 Hour 30 Minutes **Maximum Marks: 50**

Part A

Multiple Choice Question

Answer all questions

Each question carries 1 mark

1. b) To measure disparities between men and women in development outcomes

2. b).Gender-biased allocation of food and

3 c). Occupational segregation

4 c) It serves as a tool for increasing transparency and accountability by making government commitments to gender equality explicit and trackable

5. a) 37%

6.c) Women's life expectancy

7. b).Cultural norms and unpaid care work restrict women's entry into the workforce.

8. a).CEDAW (Convention on the Elimination of All Forms of Discrimination Against Women)

9. c). To analyse how government revenues and expenditures affect different genders and to ensure budgets promote gender equality.

10. b).Article 39(d)

11. d).Gender Development Index

12. b).Patriarchal social norms

13. d).Kerala

14. b). It provides a comprehensive understanding of gender issues

15. a).To address the need for a single, powerful UN entity to lead gender equality efforts.

Part B

Short Answer Questions
Answer any 10 questions

Each question carries 2 marks

16. The position of women in Kerala with respect to education and health—is far stronger than in most other Indian states Kerala-highest female literacy rates in India-As of 2025, Kerala's female literacy rate - approximately 92%, compared to the national female average of about 70%-Kerala's low dropout and high female enrolment at all education levels reflect progressive societal attitudes-Kerala also leads India in women's health outcomes-The state's Maternal Mortality Ratio (MMR) stands at 30, the lowest in India and far better than the national average of 130-Life expectancy for women in Kerala is the highest in the country—over 78 years on average-Infant mortality rates and under-five mortality rates in Kerala are comparable to those of developed nations and significantly lower than those in northern states such as Uttar Pradesh and Bihar.[Give full marks for the correct explanation]

17. National Rural Livelihood Mission, Stand up India scheme-Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana.

Beti bachao, Beti padhavo, gender budgeting-Pradhan Mantri Mathru Vandana Yojana, One stop centre scheme-Gender budgeting-NRLM-SAGYPMUY(Give full marks for any two programs/policies)

18. An example of gender discrimination in education is when girls are discouraged from studying science, technology, engineering, and mathematics (STEM) subjects because of stereotypes that these fields are more suitable for boys- In some rural areas, families may prioritize sending boys to school while keeping girls at home to help with domestic work [Give full marks for any two example)
19. The observed deficit in the number of women in a population compared to what would be expected if gender ratios were naturally balanced-coined by Amartya Sen,- Social issue: reflects deep-rooted gender inequality -systemic injustice- increased violence against women- human trafficking-social instability -it undermines women's rights- limits their participation in education and the workforce-weakens the overall development of a society. work [Give 1 mark for the definition and 1 mark for any two social issues)
20. Inclusive governance-Correcting historical imbalances-Leadership development-Social mobility-emphasis on community welfare by focussing health, education etc.-transparency and accountability(Give 2 marks for any two points)

21. Underrepresentation in leadership-Gender wage gap-work-life balance-Gender bias and

discrimination (Give 2 marks for any two points)

22. Develop gender equality strategies-policy framework-provide financial aid-promote inclusive practices etc. (Give 2 marks for any two points)

23. A gender policy is a set of rules and strategies used by governments and organizations to promote fairness between men and women. It helps reduce gender-based differences in areas like jobs, education. (Give full mark for the correct explanation)

24. LGBT+ stands for Lesbian, Gay, Bisexual, and Transgender, with the plus sign (+) representing other sexual orientations and gender identities such as Queer, Intersex, Asexual, Pansexual, and others. (Give full mark for the correct explanation)

25. Stereotypes About Women: Emotional and Sensitive- Physically Weak-Caregivers by Nature-Better at Household Work-Less Capable in Leadership-Stereotypes About Men: Breadwinners-Physically Strong and Aggressive-Not Suitable for Caregiving Roles-Sexually Dominant(Give 2 marks for any two points)

26. **(Value liberally)** The "glass ceiling" refers to an invisible barrier that prevents women and marginalized groups from advancing to higher positions of power or leadership, despite having the qualifications and abilities.

27. Increased female workforce participation-changing household roles-rise in non-traditional family structure-delaying marriage and childbirth - intergenerational tensions within families over gender roles and expectation (Give 2 marks for any two points)

28. Traditional gender roles-social stigma and discrimination (Give full mark for the any two relevant points)

29. HDI-Human Development Index, measures overall development of country based on education, life expectancy and income, whereas GDI-Gender Development Index, adjust the HDI to reflect gender disparities in the same three areas (Give full mark for the correct explanation.

Part C

Short Essay Questions Answer any 3 questions

Each question carries 5 marks

30. Occupational segregation—where men and women are concentrated in different jobs or industries—significantly contributes to the gender wage gap by channeling women into lower-paying sectors and undervalued roles. Occupational segregation- horizontal, vertical-Femaledominated occupations (e.g., nursing, teaching, and administrative work) tend to pay less than maledominated ones requiring comparable skills and education-

gender pay gap widened in 2025, with women earning 78 cents for every dollar earned by men in the U.S. -Occupational segregation remains one of the leading contributors to this reversal of progress, alongside workforce participation trends and caregivingrelated career breaks- Lower-Paid Sectors Are Female-Dominated- Limited Access to High-Paying Roles- Barriers to Promotion.[Give 5 marks for any five points with explanation]

31. Challenges: cultural and social norms-gender-based violence-economic disparities- limited access to education and healthcare-political underrepresentation-digital divide. Solutions: legal and policy reforms-education and awareness-economic empowerment-technology and innovation-inclusive governance [Give 5 marks for any five points with explanation]

32. Women struggle to access bank credit thereby hindering their ability to invest in agriculture or entrepreneurship, suppresses female productivity and contributes to national poverty levels-Patriarchal norms and traditional gender roles reinforce economic inequality-limited access to assets, education, and decision-making power-employment discrimination-unequal property and inheritance rights-unpaid care work etc. [Give 5 marks for any five points with explanation]

33. Increased poverty and inequality-reducing labour force participation-hindering human capital development-discourages retention of skilled workers-lower consumer spending-reduced labour market efficiency-leads to economic inequality-foster social tensions and conflict. [Give 5 marks for any five points with explanation]

34. Establish institutional frameworks- Capacity Building and Training-allocate targeted funds-Integrate gender analysis in all budget stages-engage all stakeholders- Integrate gender budgeting with broader national development goals [Give 5 marks for any five points with explanation]

35. India has implemented a broad range of government interventions and policy measures to address the feminization of poverty—These initiatives aim to improve gender equality and reduce structural disadvantages faced by women in poverty-National Rural Livelihood Mission- Stand up India scheme- Pradhan Mantri Mudra Yojana-Beti bachao-Beti padhavo-gender budgeting-Pradhan Mantri Mathru Vandana Yojana-One stop centre scheme-Deendayal Antyodaya Yojana-Samagra Shiksha etc. [Give 5 marks for any five programme/policies with explanation]

36. Unleashing human potential-helps to understand gender equity and equality-encouraging equal access to schooling and skill development-promotes gender sensitive health policies-supports human rights and social justice-reduces poverty and inequality-addresses the gender digital divide-promotes inclusive growth-promotes economic growth and development—recognises the value of unpaid work-enhances policy effectiveness.

[Give 5 marks for any five points with explanation]